

Installing Terraform via Homebrew

A step-by-step setup guide including environment PATH diagnosis & resolution.

This guide walks through the standard, robust process for installing **HashiCorp Terraform** on Apple macOS using **Homebrew**, along with resolving the common `brew command not found` issue on Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3) Macs.

1 Install Homebrew

If you do not already have Homebrew installed on your Mac, run the official Homebrew installation script. **Ensure you execute this as a single continuous line:**

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

Important Note:

Wait for this script to complete fully. It will prompt for your macOS administrator password and standard developer tool confirmations. Do not interrupt or combine this with subsequent commands.

2 Diagnose & Fix Homebrew PATH Initialization

On Apple Silicon Macs, Homebrew installs into `/opt/homebrew`. If running `brew` results in `command not found: brew`, your shell needs to load the Homebrew environment variables into your `$PATH`.

A. Immediate Temporary Fix (Current Terminal Session)

Run the following command to make `brew` accessible in your current shell tab immediately:

```
eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv)"
```

B. Permanent Fix (Persists across all future terminal windows)

To ensure `brew` is loaded automatically whenever you open a new Zsh terminal session, append the initialization command to your `~/.zprofile`:

```
echo 'eval "$(/opt/homebrew/bin/brew shellenv)"' >> ~/.zprofile
source ~/.zprofile
```

3 Install HashiCorp Terraform

Once Homebrew is active in your terminal, run the installation command separately from the Homebrew setup script:

```
brew install hashicorp/tap/terraform
```

This command taps the official HashiCorp repository and downloads the latest stable release of the Terraform CLI.

4 Verify the Installation

After installation finishes, confirm that Terraform is installed correctly and present on your shell `$PATH` by checking its version:

```
terraform -version
```

Expected Output:

You should see version details similar to:

```
Terraform v1.x.x  
on darwin_arm64
```